

Sofia Bernal

Digital Policy & Responsible Technology · Technology Governance, Contracts & Compliance · Digital Equity

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PROFILE

Digital policy and responsible technology professional from Mexico, completing an MA in Internet Equalities at UAL's Creative Computing Institute, a programme that examines how power relations and inequalities are embedded across full-stack technologies, from data and archives to infrastructure and code. I bring five years at Microsoft LATAM governing complex technology agreements with governments, universities and regulated financial institutions across Mexico, Argentina, Uruguay and Chile, working alongside legal, compliance and finance teams to embed governance and risk management into how institutions adopt technology. My research looks at how describing and cataloguing records, in physical and digital archives, shapes what can be known and remembered about people's lives. I care about building technology in people's best interests rather than deepening social divides and natural depletion, and about making complex regulatory, technical and social systems legible for decision-makers, civil society and young people. I write Cableado, a bilingual newsletter on technology policy, internet governance and Latin American digital culture.

Core competencies: Digital policy & internet governance · Responsible technology & AI ethics · Technology contract governance, risk & compliance · Public-sector and education stakeholder engagement · Capacity building & enablement · Policy research & bilingual public writing (ES/EN) · Data analysis (SQL, Tableau) · Creative coding & prototyping (p5.js, Supabase)

EXPERIENCE

Researcher, MA Internet Equalities | University of the Arts London, Creative Computing Institute 2025 – present

- Postgraduate researcher in a practice-based programme on how structures of oppression are organised and perpetuated across full-stack technologies, with pathways in digital advocacy, social and policy innovation, and ethics and responsible technology consulting.
- Research how cataloguing, metadata and digitisation decisions re-encode exclusion in institutional archives (thesis: the invisibilisation of feminised care in colonial photographic archives and contemporary social media); audited generative AI image outputs (ComfyUI) for biased depictions of Latin American families and reported findings to the course; developed an ethical framework, drawn from the One Thousand and One Nights, for a public robotics performance.
- Built a working practice-based counter-archive prototype (p5.js, Supabase); ethical framework staged at the International Conference of Social Robotics; moderated a public dialogue and recorded podcast with author Erdem Ovacik (The Next Democracy); represented the programme as student ambassador at 5 recruitment events (2 in person, 3 online) and created 2 Instagram videos and 3 articles for its outreach.

Writer & Editor | Cableado, independent bilingual newsletter (ES/EN) 2026 – present

- Independent Spanish/English publication translating technology policy, internet governance and feminist technology debates for Latin American audiences.
- Research and write policy analysis on regulatory change, including Mexico's data-protection reform (LFPDPPP), the dissolution of INAI and the Pegasus surveillance cases, alongside essays on algorithmic folklore and how online communities are constituted.
- Published 10 long-form analyses read across 4 countries; an essay on public data cultures was shared by researcher Jonathan Gray, whose work it discusses.

Commercial Executive | Microsoft LATAM (Mexico, Argentina, Uruguay, Chile) 2021 – 2025

- Led the commercial and contractual strategy of complex technology agreements for public-sector, education and financial-services institutions, a role that balances customer outcomes with business objectives, embeds compliance in deal-making and manages governance and risk across the full contract lifecycle.
- Translated licensing terms, T&Cs, consumption models and investment structures for senior decision-makers; orchestrated legal, compliance, finance, deal desk and partner teams; adapted agreements to public procurement conditions and regulated-sector requirements for universities (Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Universidad de Chile), banks and government secretariats in Argentina; ran a T-12 governance methodology that started contract review 12 months before expiry.
- Achieved a 130%+ renewal and win rate across 5–10 concurrent enterprise, 20–30 corporate and 40–60 SMB renewals; structured a \$7M+ agreement with Banco de Crédito e Inversiones (BCI), including a \$3M Azure commitment; preserved Argentina's government accounts through the 2023 change of administration; managed a portfolio of 500+ SMB, 100+ corporate and 30+ enterprise accounts; named Sustainability Champion for Microsoft Mexico, leading internal learning sessions (2023–2024).

Co-founder, Indigenous Pillar (Employee Resource Group) | Microsoft Mexico

Alongside commercial role

- Co-founded the Indigenous pillar of Microsoft Mexico's employee resource groups, the internal groups that represent communities and causes within the company, following the model of established Indigenous pillars in New Zealand and Brazil.
- Built the case for a Mexican pillar grounded in national data (19.4% of Mexico's population aged 3 and over self-identifies as Indigenous, INEGI Census 2020); co-led the group's agenda and designed a joint public event between Microsoft and the Museum of the National Institute of Indigenous Peoples (INPI), with Microsoft funding the programme and speakers and the museum hosting it.
- Grew the pillar to a community of ~20 members and delivered the Microsoft-INPI event, connecting a global technology company with a national cultural institution.

Partner Technology Strategist | Microsoft Mexico

2020 – 2021

- Enabled Microsoft's partner ecosystem in Mexico to build technical capabilities and meet Microsoft's certification standards (Silver and Gold competencies).
- Designed enablement content and upselling/cross-selling playbooks, guided partners through certification requirements, and advised partners integrating their own IP into Microsoft marketplaces.
- Curated Microsoft's official partner list for Mexico, assessing organisations against Microsoft's standards framework, and supported partners in achieving and upgrading Silver and Gold certifications, leading to my move into an enterprise commercial role.

Payments & Risk Analyst | Grow (formerly Flinto), Mexico

2019 – 2021

- Risk and payments analyst at Flinto, a digital-wallet startup, continuing in the role through its acquisition by Grow, the micromobility company formed by the Grin and Yellow merger.
- Monitored transaction, fraud and chargeback risk across Stripe, Conekta and Adyen using SQL and Tableau, and reported risk metrics to leadership: early grounding in financial-risk controls and consumer protection in digital payments.
- Contributed to a reduction in chargeback rates through ongoing risk monitoring, and kept the risk function running without interruption through the acquisition.

EARLY CAREER & VOLUNTEERING

Project Advisor | SEDESU, Secretariat of Sustainable Development, Mexico

2020

- Assessed and monitored technology implementation projects within the State Programme for Technology and Innovation Development, aligning them with sustainable development goals.

Museum Volunteer | INPI, National Institute of Indigenous Peoples, Mexico City

2023 – 2024

- Guided diverse visitor groups, including school tours, through exhibitions on Indigenous histories, adapting communication to each audience.

FORMAL EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MA Internet Equalities | University of the Arts London, Creative Computing Institute

2025 – present

Bachelor's in Sociology | Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM)

2018 – 2023

BSc Industrial Engineering & Innovation Mgmt. | Universidad Panamericana (exchange: Korea University)

2017 – 2022

Internet Governance (certificate) | Internet Society

2026

History and policy principles of Internet governance, the multistakeholder model, actors and stakeholders, infrastructure, standards and protocols, regulatory frameworks and national regulation, multilingualism, and cybersecurity from policy and technical perspectives.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (working proficiency)

REFERENCES

Ceren Yuksel: MA Director, UAL Creative Computing Institute; former UNHCR specialist in identity management, information analysis and statelessness; creator of Refugee Data Minder. c.yuksel@arts.ac.uk

René Lopez Bedolla: Coordinator of Cultural and Digital Projects, Museum of the National Institute of Indigenous Peoples (INPI), Mexico City. [linkedin.com/in/rene-bedolla](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rene-bedolla)

Rodrigo Astiazaran: Senior Director, Microsoft Latin America, responsible for large corporate and mid-market accounts across the region. rastiaza@microsoft.com

Patricio Molina: Director General, KPMG; former Microsoft colleague who co-founded the Indigenous employee resource group pillar in Mexico with Sofia. patriciomolina@kpmg.com